

Global Semiconductors

Global Semi: South Korea Equipment Import Tracker (Aug 26): Import +87% YoY



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Korea Customs Service released Aug 2026 semiconductor equipment import data on September 15th. We have extracted and analyzed relevant information that has strong significance for our coverage companies. *The import data can be downloaded here:* [South Korea SPE Import](#).

Strong Korean SPE imports. Overall, South Korean semi equipment imports in August were globally **+87% YoY / -3% MoM**. YTD YoY improved to 45% (from July with 41%). Imports for Japanese SPE were +97% YoY and +9% MoM.

Strong tester import. Advantest's memory tester revenue has good correlation with South Korea tester import data, which was **-27% MoM / +79% YoY**. Regression suggests Advantest to see a +26% QoQ increase in SepQ South Korea tester revenue with 2-month data. For reference, consensus projects Advantest revenue to be +18% QoQ, to which Korean import suggests upside.

South Korea's WFE imports from the Netherlands reached €708mn in August, down -3% MoM but up 108% YoY. Based on our regression model, we estimate ASML Korea's Q3 system sales at €2.11bn, down 25% QoQ but more than doubling YoY. This suggests that Korea would account for roughly 24% of total Q3 system sales, a sequential decline of about 19 percentage points. Overall, this points to sustained revenue momentum in South Korea and in Memory, likely supported by meaningful DRAM capacity expansion and fast adoption of the 1c node which has considerably higher Litho intensity

Japan WFE import recovered. South Korean import data for the relevant categories for TEL (CVD, dry etching, cleaning, coater & developer, RTP, etc.) in August was **+9% MoM / +113% YoY**. Our regression suggests a growth of +22% in SepQ revenue with 2-month data. The regression-based Korea import implies slight upside vs. consensus of +18% QoQ.

For Samsung & SK hynix, we find their combined capex has been reasonably correlated with the import data. Equipment import in 2QCY26 grew further over 1Q, in line with the QoQ rebound in capex reported by Samsung and hynix for 2Q. Going forward, hynix guided ~75% growth in 2026 capex, and we expect similar growth from Samsung. Hence, future capex and equipment import is likely to see continued growth.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	15 Sep	Price	TTM	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
			2026		Rel.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
			Closing	Target	Perf.							
			Price									
6857.JP (Advantest)	O	JPY	30,160	45,800	83.0%	JPY	513.30	948.96	1,088.87	58.8	31.8	27.7
ASML (ASML)	O	USD	1,575.15	2,859.00	67.4%	USD	27.95	44.01	60.58	48.8	31.0	22.5
ASML.NA (ASML)	O	EUR	1,378.80	2,500.00	74.8%	EUR	24.72	38.91	53.56	55.8	35.4	25.7
8035.JP (Tokyo Electron)	O	JPY	50,650	79,300	89.6%	JPY	1,250.88	1,687.17	2,635.81	40.5	30.0	19.2
005930.KS (SEC- Samsung)	O	KRW	248,500	440,000	189.5%	KRW	6,611.53	48,393	77,273	37.6	5.1	3.2
005935.KS (SEC-Pref - Samsung)	O	KRW	187,100	374,000	169.8%	KRW	6,611.53	48,393	77,273	28.3	3.9	2.4
SMSN.LI (Samsung)	O	USD	4,530.00	7,350.00	204.1%	USD	116.15	812.39	1,290.80	39.0	5.6	3.5
000660.KS (SK hynix)	O	KRW	1,690,000	3,300,000	362.2%	KRW	60,341	395,677	568,862	28.0	4.3	3.0
JPL			2,637.54									
SPX			7,619.98									
EDME			1,577.08									
ASIA			1,938.16									
EM			1,805.56									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate Tokyo Electron (PT=¥79,300), ASML (PT=€2,500.00) and Advantest (PT=¥45,800) Outperform.

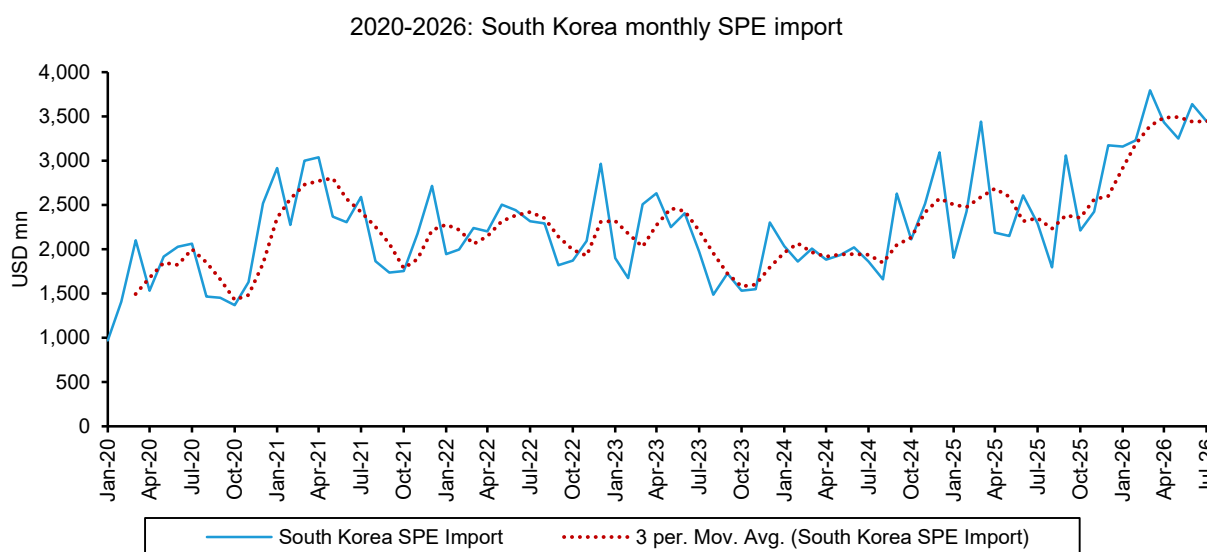
We rate Samsung Electronics OP with PT=KRW 440,000 and SK hynix OP with PT=KRW 3,300,000.

DETAILS

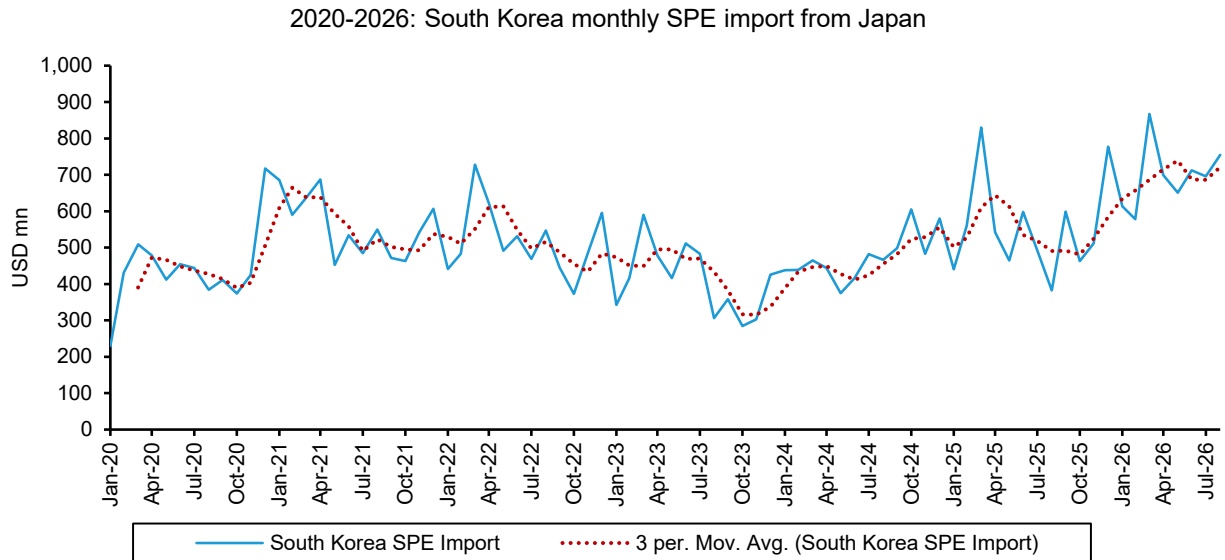
SOUTH KOREA SEMI EQUIPMENT IMPORTS OVERALL

- Overall, South Korea semi equipment imports were +50% YoY globally in Jul '26, Japan SPE was +41% (Exhibit 1, Exhibit 2).
- MoM shows decline — globally -5% and -2% from Japan, and 3-month moving average sequentially was flat sequentially for both global and Japan import.
- Historical data shows good correlation between the South Korea equipment imports and the combined capex of Samsung & SK hynix (Exhibit 3). 1QCY26 capex came down QoQ for both Samsung and SK hynix, despite rising equipment import data, likely due to seasonality and also as some infrastructure investments were front loaded in 4Q25. Equipment import data grew higher in 2QCY26 vs 1Q, suggesting continued strong momentum in capital spending, and both Samsung and SK hynix's capex rebounded QoQ in 2QCY26 (Exhibit 4). Going forward, hynix guided ~75% YoY increase in 2026 capex and we expect similar growth from Samsung as well. Capex will have relatively more focus on infrastructure and strategic equipment this year, as they accelerate their fab construction schedule. So we expect future capex to likely grow even stronger than import data soon.

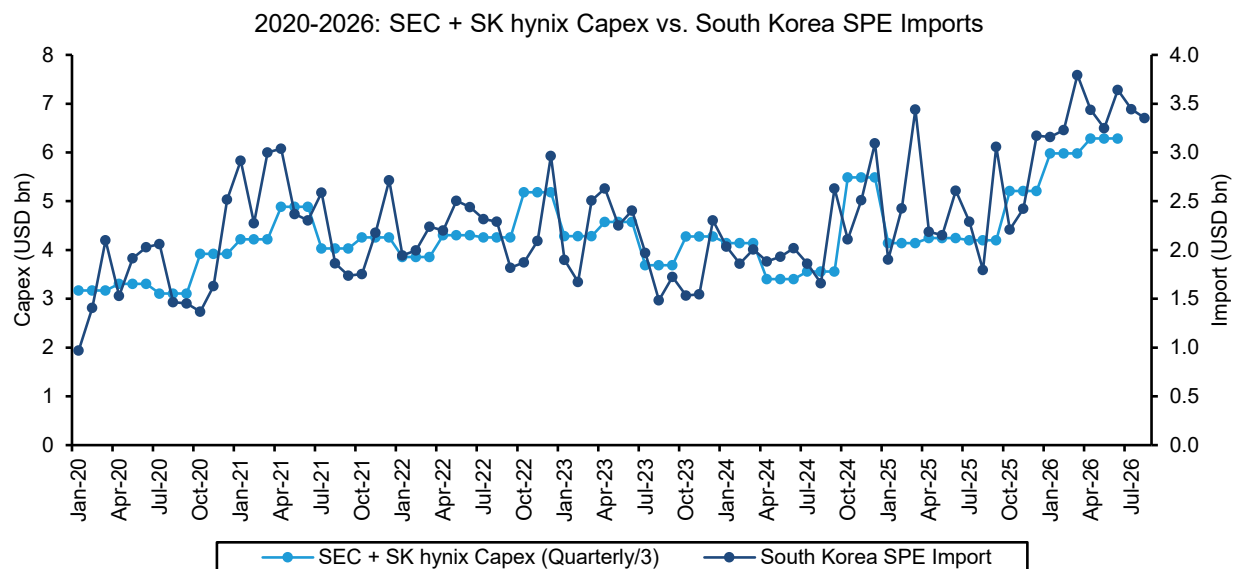
EXHIBIT 1: **August South Korea imports for SPE was \$3.4bn, -3% MoM.**



Source: Korea Customs Services, Bernstein analysis

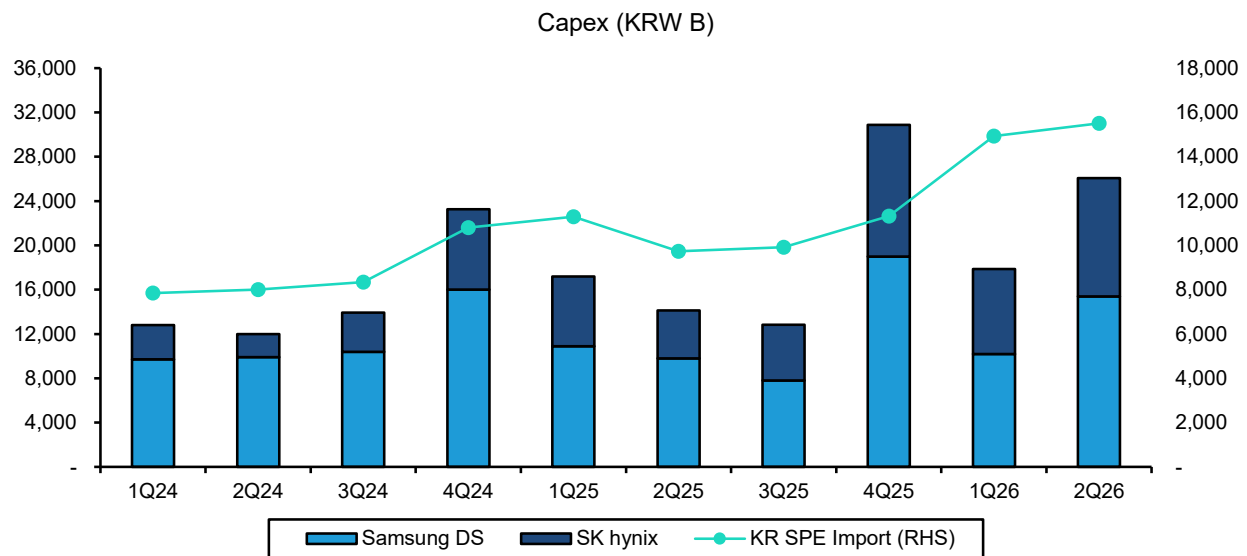
EXHIBIT 2: August South Korea imports for Japanese SPE was \$755mn, +9% MoM.

Source: Korea Customs Services, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: South Korea SPE monthly import data has good directional correlation with Samsung and SK hynix's quarterly capex.

Source: Company disclosures, Korea Customs Services, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 4: Both Samsung and hynix reported notable QoQ rebound in capex in 2QCY26, and we expect continued growth in capex in the following quarters.

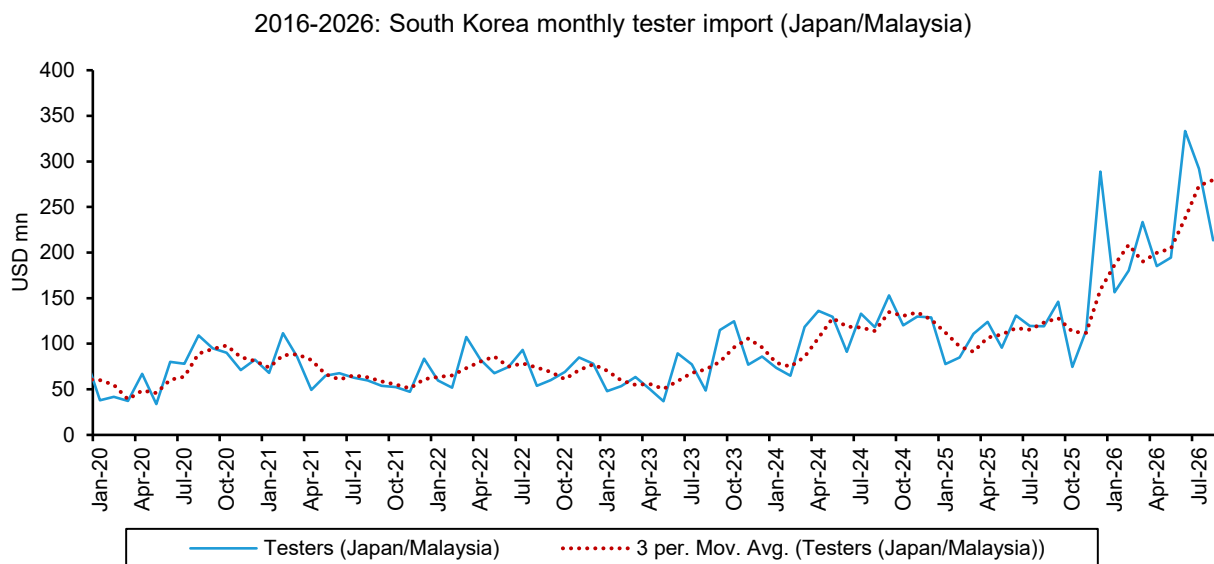


Source: Company reports, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

ADVANTEST – SOUTH KOREA TESTER IMPORT DATA

- Advantest memory tester revenue is highly correlated to the Korean tester import (Exhibit 6). Korean import of testers from Japan and Malaysia was -27% MoM and +79% YoY. 3-month average was +2% MoM (Exhibit 5).
- Our regression indicates SepQ Korean sales for Advantest of +26% QoQ (Exhibit 7, Exhibit 8), which suggest upside to SepQ consensus for Advantest corporate revenue of +18%.

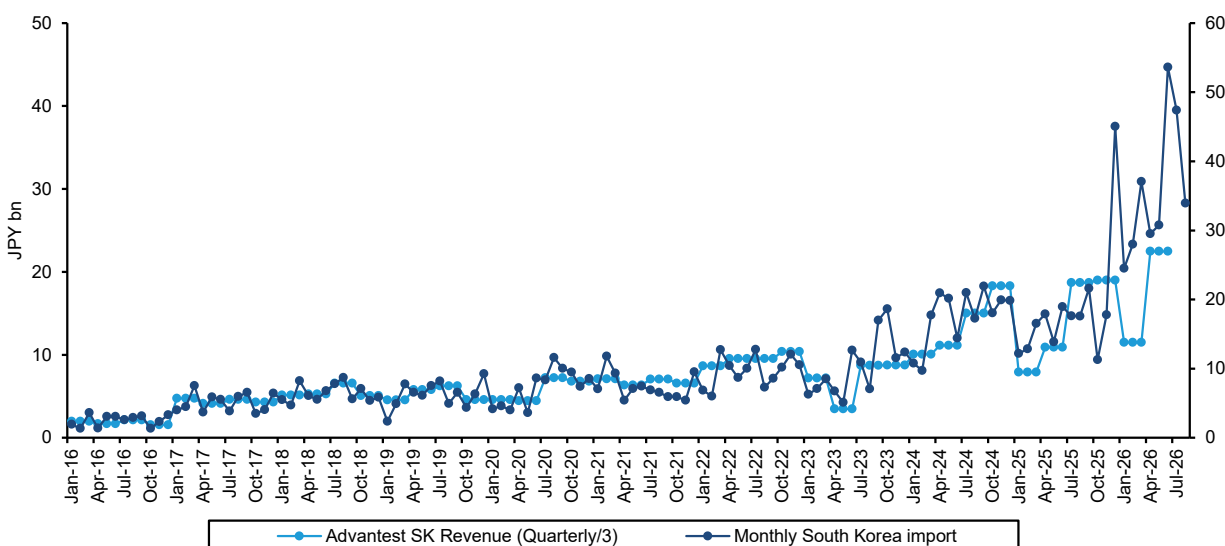
EXHIBIT 5: August tester imports from Japan and Malaysia collectively was -27% MoM.



Source: Korea Customs Service, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 6: South Korea tester imports data shows good directional correlation with Advantest's South Korea sales.

2016-2026: Advantest South Korea Revenue vs. South Korea Tester Imports



Source: Company disclosures, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein analysis.

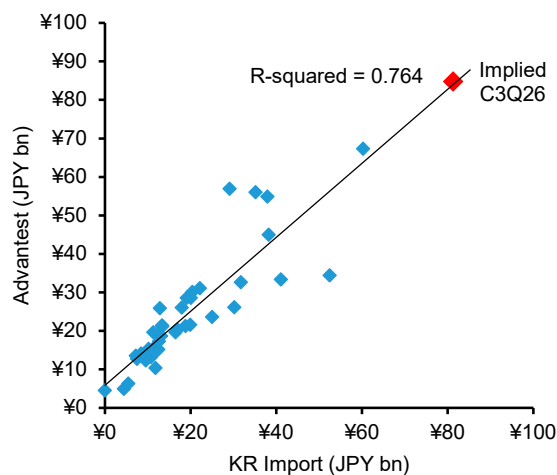
EXHIBIT 7: Our regression suggests +26% QoQ for Advantest's Q2 South Korea sales.

	Revenue (JPY bn)		QoQ
	1QFY27 (2QCY26)	2QFY27E (3QCY26E)	
South Korea Sales	67	85	26%
Total Sales	367		
Bernstein		441	20%
Consensus		433	18%
Korea %	18%		
Bernstein		19%	1%
Consensus		20%	1%

Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 8: Advantest's Quarterly Korean sales shows good correlation with 2-month Korean monthly imports.

Advantest Quarterly KR Sales vs. KR 2M Import: 1QCY16-2QCY26



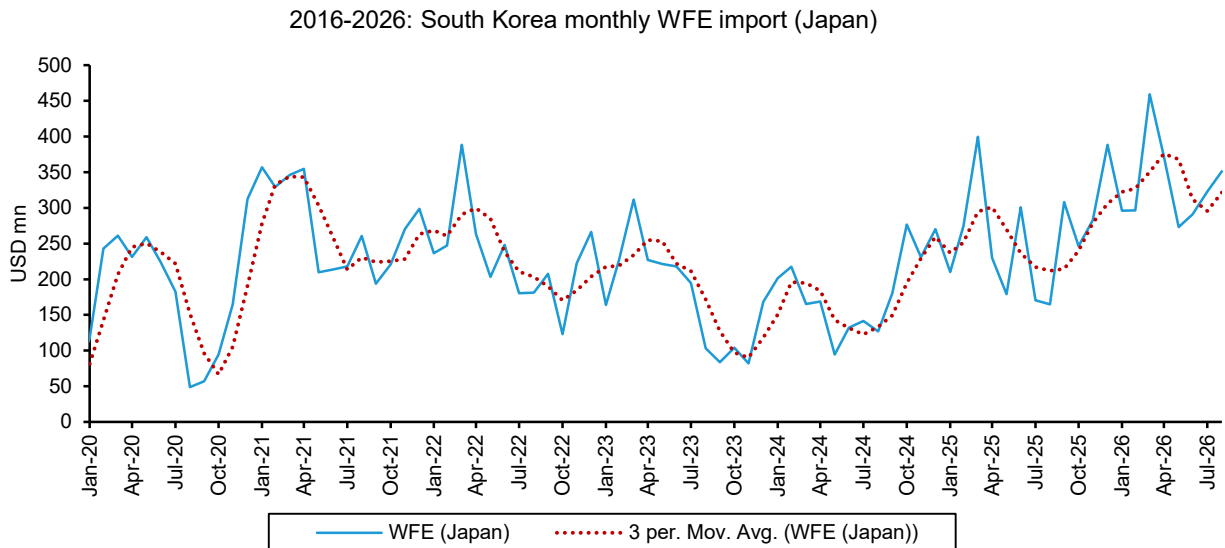
Source: Company reports, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

TOKYO ELECTRON – SOUTH KOREA IMPORT DATA

- TEL makes many equipments (CVD, dry etching, cleaning, coater & developer, RTP, etc.) and we try to group all the categories together. South Korean import data for the relevant categories has relatively high correlation with TEL's Korea revenue (Exhibit 10).
- August single-month import was +113% YoY, and +9% MoM. 3-month moving average is +9% sequentially (Exhibit 9).

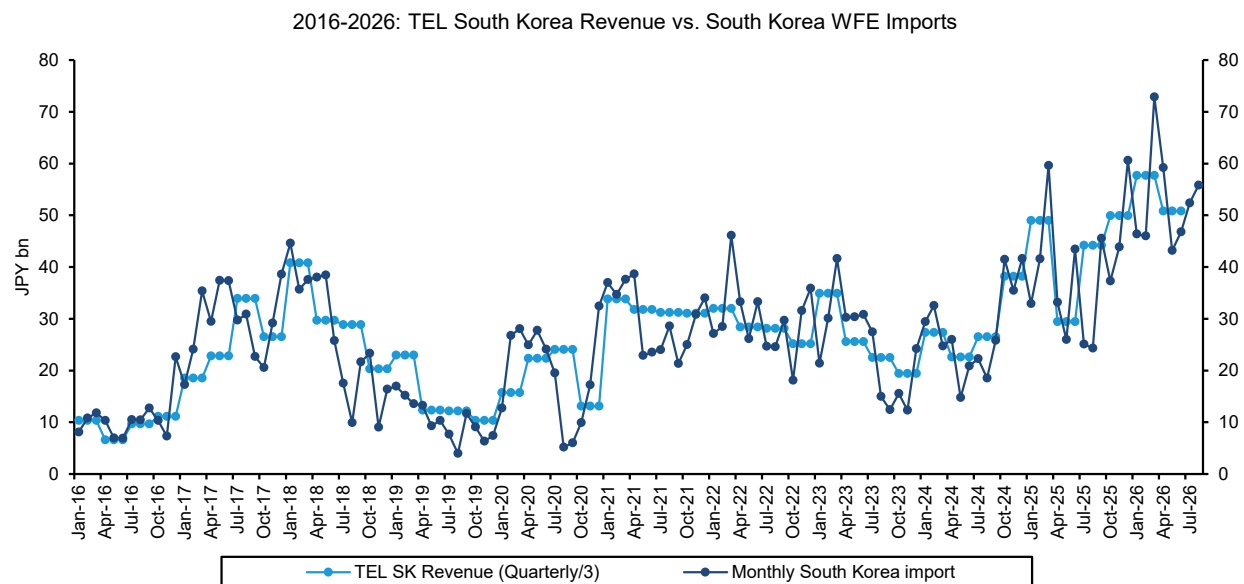
- Our regression indicates SepQ Korea sales for TEL of +22% QoQ (Exhibit 11, Exhibit 12), which indicates slight upside to SPE sales consensus of +18% QoQ.

EXHIBIT 9: **August imports from Japan for WFE equipment where TEL has exposure, were collectively +9% MoM.**



Source: Korea Customs Services, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 10: **South Korea monthly WFE imports from Japan show good directional correlation with TEL's South Korea revenue.**

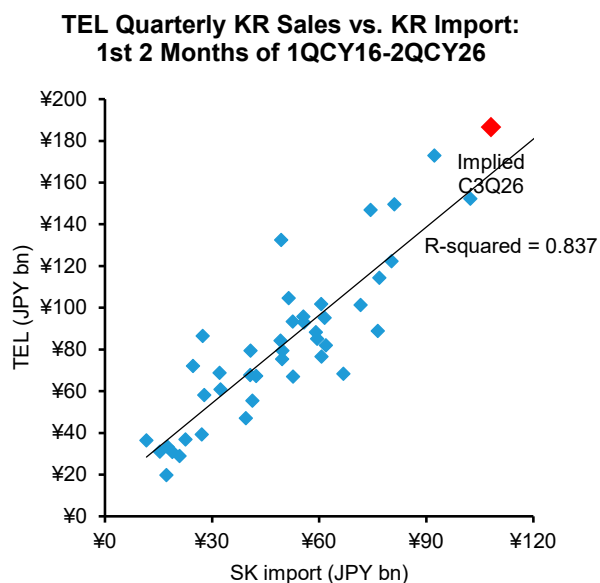


Source: Company disclosures, Korea Customs Services, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: Our regression suggests +22% QoQ for TEL's Q2 South Korea sales.

	Revenue (JPY bn)		QoQ
	1QFY27 (2QCY26)	2QFY27E (3QCY26E)	
KR Sales	152	187	22%
Total Sales	719		
Bernstein		876	22%
Consensus		851	18%
Korea %	21%		
Bernstein		21%	0%
Consensus		22%	1%

Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 12: TEL's Quarterly Korean sales shows good correlation with 2-month Korean monthly imports.

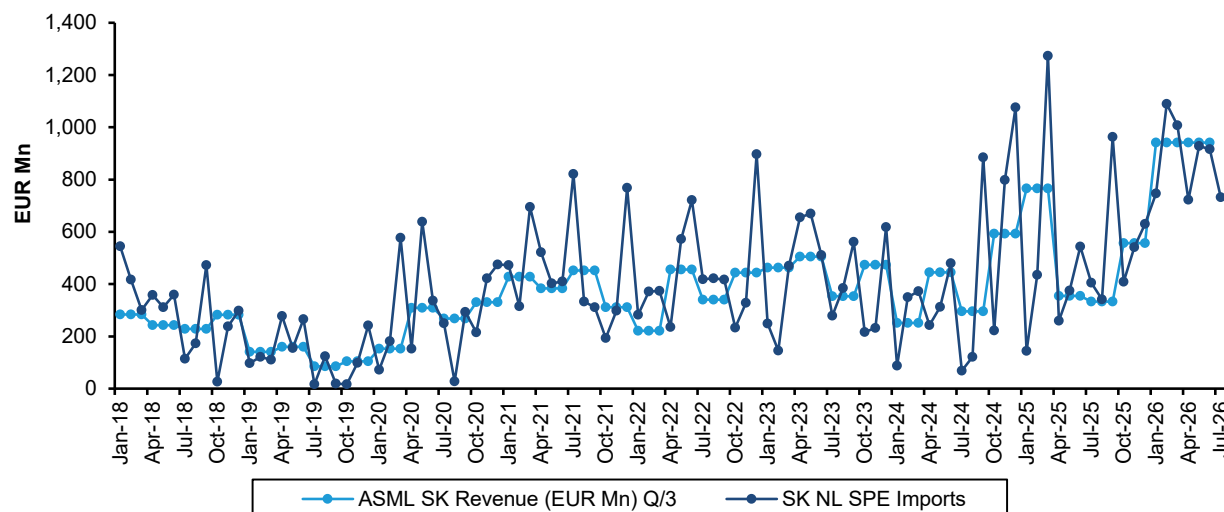
Source: Company disclosures, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

ASML – SOUTH KOREA IMPORT DATA

- ASML accounts for a significant portion of WFE imports to South Korea, totaling ~€5.0Bn in 2024 and €6.3Bn in 2025 and already €6.85bn in 2026 YTD up ~80% YoY. While monthly data tends to be volatile, the three-month moving average indicates that after a period of relative stability, imports from the Netherlands increased in the end of 2024, driven primarily by orders from DRAM players (Exhibit 13).
- South Korea's WFE equipment imports from the Netherlands reached €708mn in August, down -3% MoM but up 108% YoY. To enhance the predictive accuracy of our regression model, we use the current 2M along with the previous month's imports (a 1-month lag) to forecast ASML Korea's system sales. The regression analysis incorporating the 1-month lag shows relatively strong explanatory power, with an R^2 of approximately 84% (Exhibit 14).
- Based on this model, we estimate ASML Korea's Q3 system sales at approximately €2.11bn, down 25% sequentially but more than doubling YoY. This suggests that Korea would account for roughly 24% of total Q3 system sales, a sequential decline of about 19 percentage points. Overall, this points to sustained revenue momentum in South Korea and in Memory, likely supported by meaningful DRAM capacity expansion and fast adoption of the 1c node which has considerably higher Litho intensity (Exhibit 15, Exhibit 16).

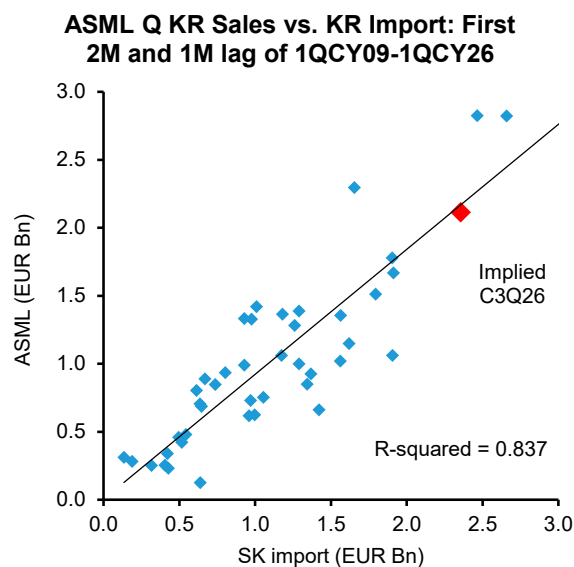
EXHIBIT 13: South Korea monthly SPE imports from Netherlands shows good directional correlation with ASML's South Korea revenue divided by 3. August Litho Imports of €708mn was down 3% MoM but up ~108% YoY.

2018-2026: ASML Korea Revenue vs Korea NL SPE Imports



Source: Company reports, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 14: Regressing ASML Korea's quarterly system sales on the first 2-month plus 1-month lag of import data, we obtain an R^2 of 84% and estimate that Q3 ASML Korea revenue will reach €2.11bn, down 25% QoQ from the record Q2, but more than doubling YoY.



Company reports, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

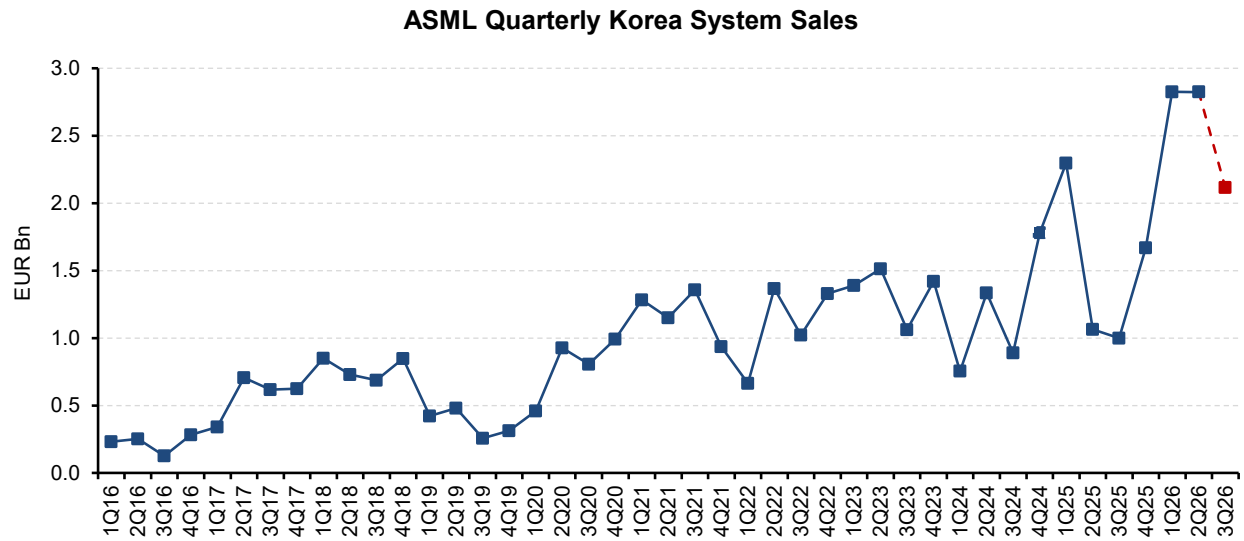
Source: Company reports, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 15: Our regression indicates very strong KR sales at €2.11Bn, down 25% sequentially due to the record level reached last quarter, implying that KR accounts for approximately 24% of total ASML system sales.

	Revenue (EUR Mn)			YoY	QoQ
	3QFY25	2QFY26	3QFY26E		
ASML Korea Sales	1,000	2,823	2,114	111%	-25%
ASML System Sales	5,554	6,565			
Bernstein			8,839	59%	35%
Consensus			8,809	59%	34%
Korea as % of System Sales	18%	43%			
Bernstein			24%	6%	-19%
Consensus			24%	6%	-19%

Source: Company reports, Bloomberg, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 16: **We estimate KR system sales at €2.11bn in Q3, declining 25% QoQ but more than doubling YoY.**



Source: Company reports, Korea Customs Service, Bernstein estimates and analysis

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

Bernstein is part of a joint venture between Société Générale (SG) and AllianceBernstein, L.P. (AB). Unless specifically noted otherwise, for purposes of these disclosures, references to Bernstein's "affiliates" relate to both SG and AB and their respective affiliates.

VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Advantest Corp**

We set a price target of ¥45,800 using a P/E multiple of 40x against our forward Q5-Q8 EPS estimate.

ASML Holding NV

For ASML, we apply a 40x P/E multiple to our Q5-8 EPS estimate to get a rounded PT of €2,500. For the ASML US listing we apply the EUR/US\$ exchange rate to get to a rounded PT of USD 2,859.

Tokyo Electron Ltd

We set a ¥79,300 price target using a P/E multiple of 28x against our forward Q5-Q8 EPS estimate.

Samsung Electronics Co Ltd

We value Samsung Electronics with 6.2x of forward 5Q-8Q EPS of KRW71,172 and arrive at price target of KRW 440,000 for its common shares, KRW374,000 for preferred shares, and US\$7,350 for GDR.

SK Hynix Inc

We value SK hynix with 6.2x of forward 5Q-8Q EPS of KRW536,158 and arrive at price target of KRW3,300,000.

RISKS**Advantest Corp**

There are a number of downside risks to our Advantest target price: (1) End demand of AI-related production such as GPUs and HBM resulting in both multiple and earning power fluctuations (2) Changes in competitive environment (3) Exchange rate fluctuation.

ASML Holding NV

Downside risks to our price target for ASML include margins coming below expectation because of the higher cost to commercialise EUV and advance EUV to new generations, larger than expected China over-stocking, weaker than expected WFE market, slower technology migration and the threat from other technologies in the long run, and further tightened export control on China customers.

Tokyo Electron Ltd

There are a number of downside risks to our TEL target price: (1) Changes in US trade restriction which are unfavorable to China's and global semiconductor capex (2) Slowdown in global semiconductor demand including both logic and memory, which trigger reduced or increased capex and capacity expansion (3) Unfavorable exchange rate fluctuation posing a downside risk to overall

Japan market

Samsung Electronics Co Ltd

The biggest downside risk to our target price is an earlier end of favorable pricing environment, which can be a result of weaker demand or higher supply. Investor sentiment and hence the valuation rewarded by investors is also a risk. China's progress in memory, especially in NAND, is a downside risk too.

SK Hynix Inc

The biggest downside risk to our target price is an earlier end of favorable pricing environment, which can be a result of weaker demand or higher supply. Investor sentiment and hence the valuation rewarded by investors is also a risk. China's progress in memory, especially in NAND, is a downside risk too.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS

Bernstein brand

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIA) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp

- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 10 pp
- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Autonomous research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Autonomous brand common stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – preferred stocks

The Autonomous brand has three categories of preferred stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to outperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

AUTONOMOUS CREDIT RESEARCH

Where this report contains investment recommendations for credit instruments, as defined in article 3(1)(35) of the Market Abuse Regulation, the information below is presented to comply with its disclosure requirements.

The report may also include reference(s) to published opinions by other Autonomous or Bernstein analysts covering the equity securities of the issuer(s) referenced herein. Please note an investment recommendation for credit instruments published by the author(s) of this report may differ from the published view of the analyst covering equity securities for the issuer(s) contained in this report and vice versa.

CREDIT RATINGS DEFINITIONS

The Autonomous brand has three categories of credit ratings:

- Credit Outperform (C-OP): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to outperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Credit Neutral (C-N): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to perform in line with the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Credit Underperform (C-UP): The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous credit ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

A list of all investment recommendations produced by the author(s) of this report alongside credit ratings history are available upon request.

It is at the sole discretion of the Firm as to when to initiate, update and cease research coverage. The Firm has established, maintains and relies on information barriers to control the flow of information contained in one or more areas (i.e. the private side)

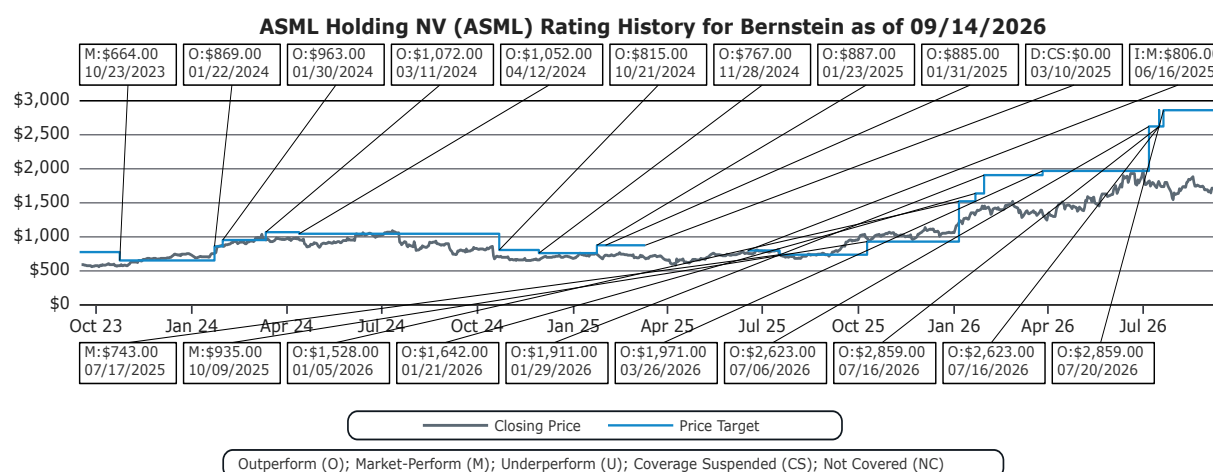
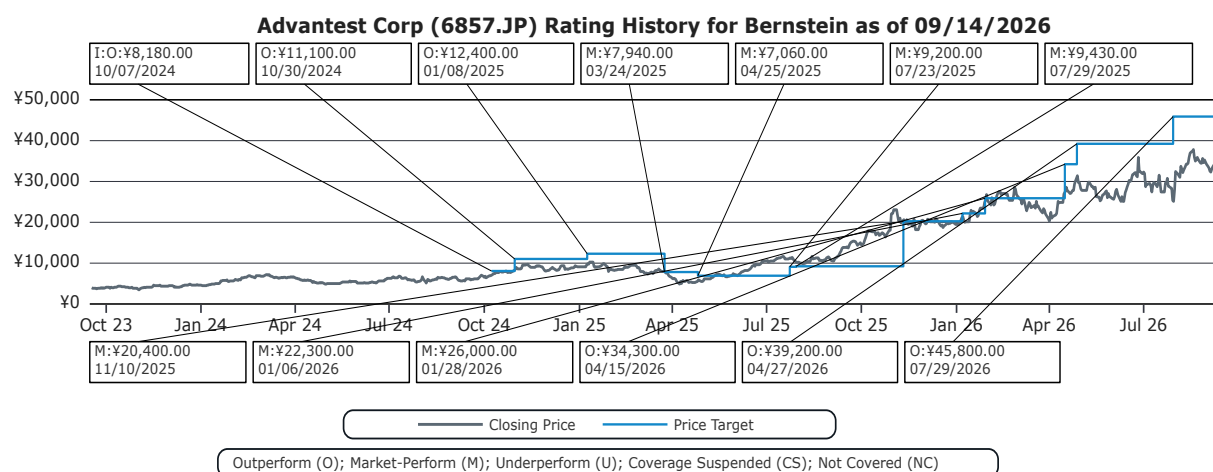
within the Firm, and into other areas, units, groups or affiliates (i.e. public side) of the Firm

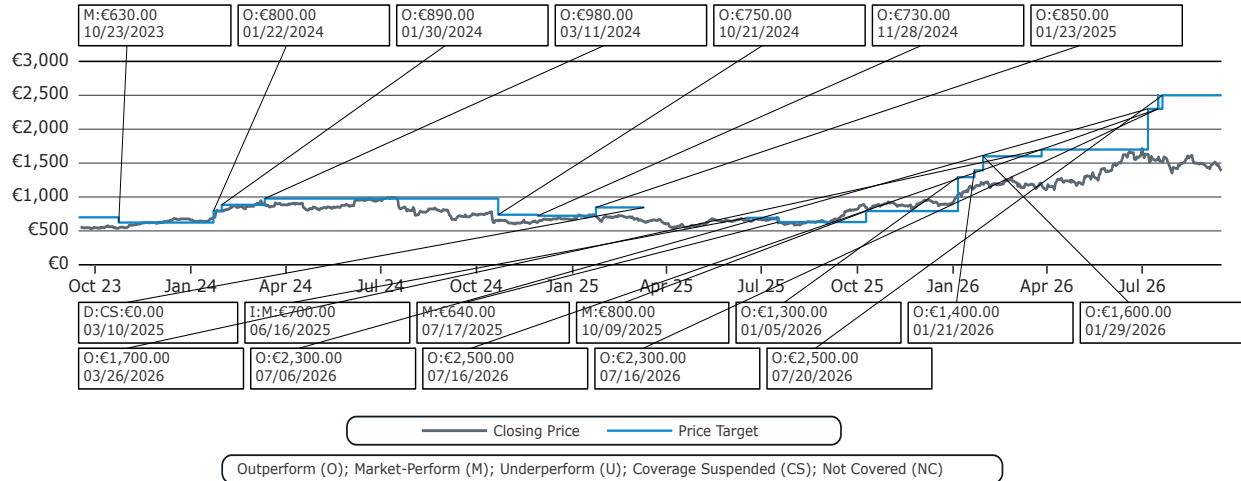
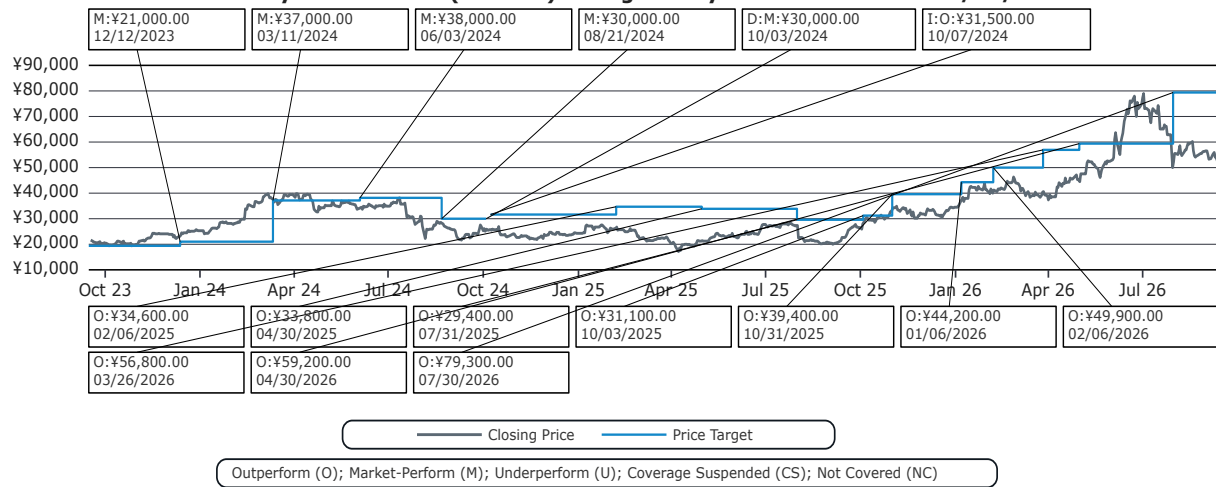
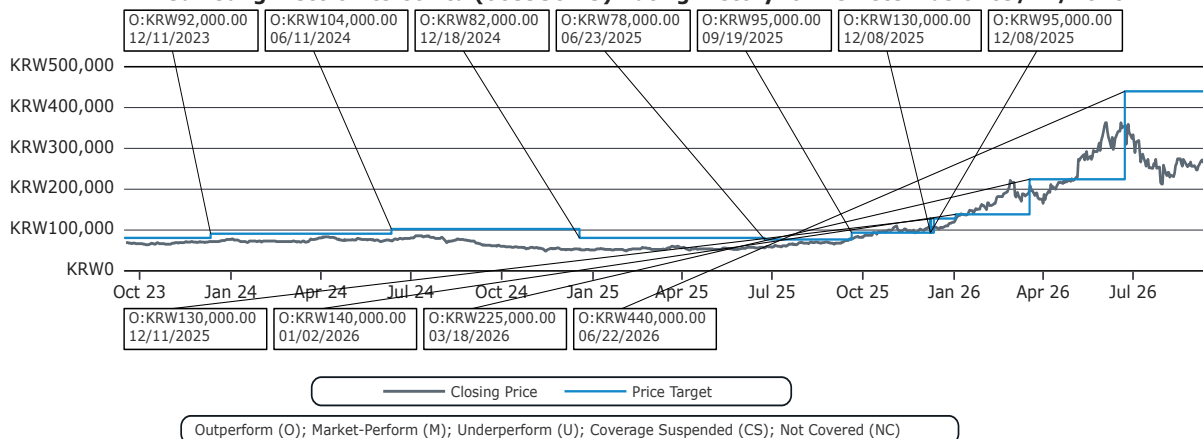
DISTRIBUTION OF EQUITY RATINGS/INVESTMENT BANKING SERVICES

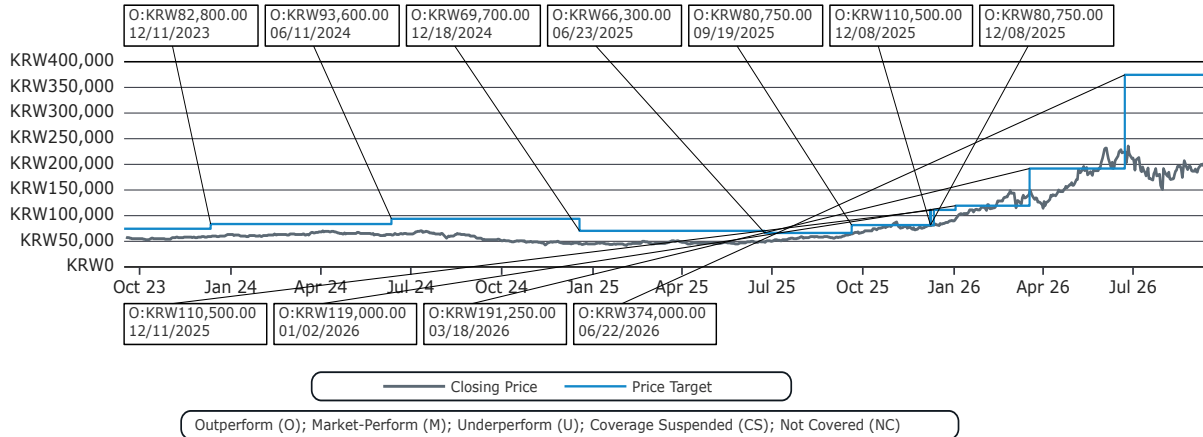
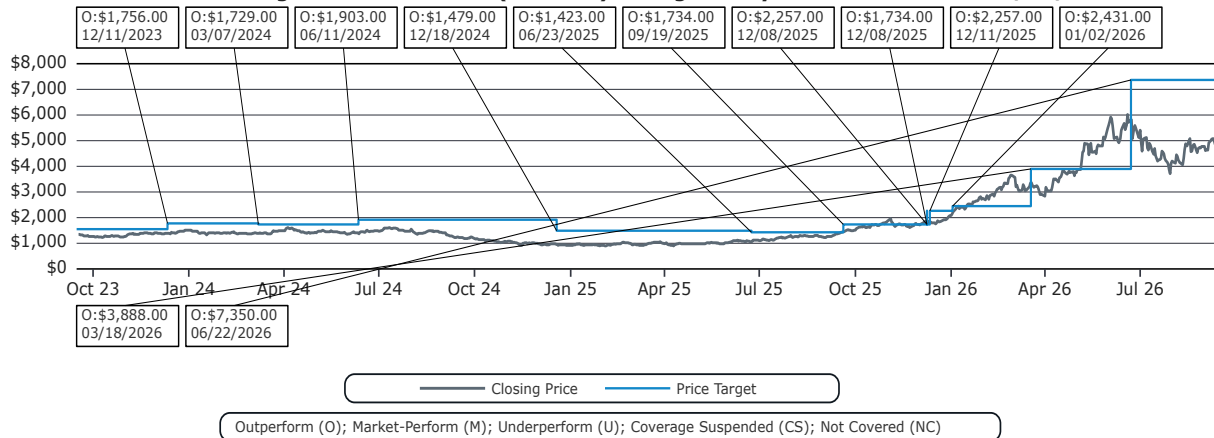
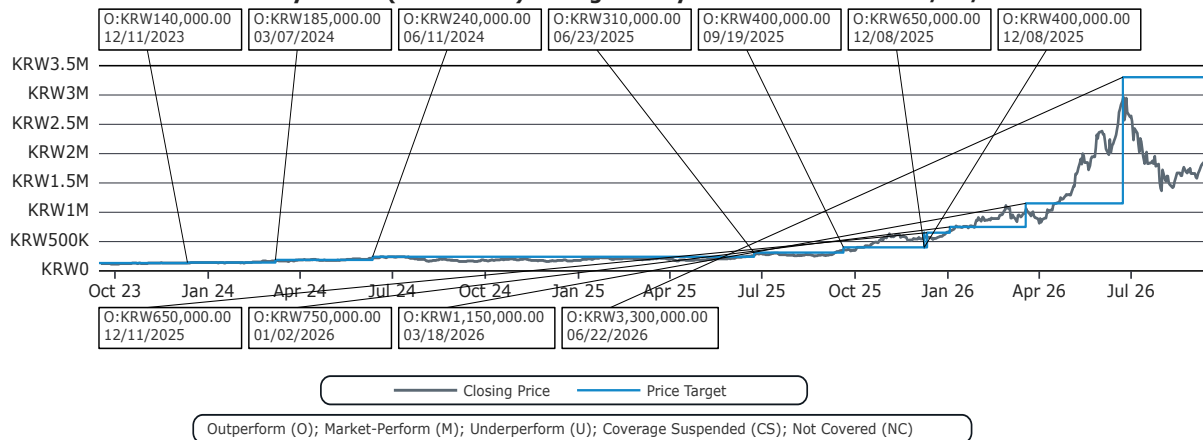
Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

PRICE CHARTS / RATINGS AND PRICE TARGET HISTORY



ASML Holding NV (ASML.NA) Rating History for Bernstein as of 09/14/2026**Tokyo Electron Ltd (8035.JP) Rating History for Bernstein as of 09/14/2026****Samsung Electronics Co Ltd (005930.KS) Rating History for Bernstein as of 09/14/2026**

Samsung Electronics Co Ltd (005935.KS) Rating History for Bernstein as of 09/14/2026**Samsung Electronics Co Ltd (SMSN.LI) Rating History for Bernstein as of 09/14/2026****SK Hynix Inc (000660.KS) Rating History for Bernstein as of 09/14/2026**

All price target and closing price data in the chart(s) above are denominated in the currency noted in the Ticker Table of this report.

CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

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